



Robin Holly

HEAD TOYMAKER

Fifteen years of toys, and one very quiet smile.

FOR ROBIN HOLLY'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Frost & Fable's head toymaker for fifteen years and the creator of the Jingle Bear, the company's best-selling toy. Known for loving Christmas, plants and the old ways of making things.

COSTUME

Easy: Green apron, reading glasses, a pencil behind the ear.

Go all out: a vintage workshop look: waistcoat, rolled sleeves, round spectacles, a green work apron and a wooden toy in hand.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** your boss for 15 years; he gave you your first job
- **Casey Sleigh:** caters every company party; you often chat in the kitchen
- **Alex Snow:** the rival toymaker every Frost & Fable designer loves to grumble about

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Be the warmest, most helpful guest in the room
- Make sure Nick's legacy is remembered
- Find out what's really happening to the company

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



Before the game

You've carved toys in the Snowbury workshop for 15 years. Your Jingle Bear is the best-selling toy Frost & Fable ever made. Everyone knows you love Christmas, plants and the old ways of making things.

YOUR SECRET: YOU KILLED NICK

At about 3:30 you took a new prototype, a dancing nutcracker, to Nick's study. The door was ajar. You heard Nick and Jordan agree to sell the company to MegaMart: the workshop closes on 15 January, and every design you ever made, the Jingle Bear included, now belongs to MegaMart. Nick laughed and said, "Robin's a sentimental fool. The designs belong to the company anyway." You left the nutcracker on the hall table and walked away.

At 4:00 you signed out the greenhouse key "for holly" and cut three foxglove stalks (your grandmother taught you which plants are poisonous). You borrowed a small saucepan and peppermint extract from Casey's kitchen, and in the workshop kitchenette you boiled the foxglove into a "peppermint syrup". You poured it into an antique bottle, tied it with red velvet ribbon and wrote the tag. You had drawn Nick in the Secret Santa, so at 6:45 you put it under the tree as your gift. At 9:00 Nick poured it into his eggnog. After he collapsed you took the bottle and dropped it out of the workshop window into the snow.

You are the killer

Your cover story: you gave Nick a hand-carved wooden reindeer for Secret Santa. You may lie about the crime. Don't confess until Inspector Noel reveals the solution. All night, keep suspicion pointed well away from the workshop, and try to win Best Liar without anyone guessing why.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Be warm and shocked: Nick was "like family". Point out that Jordan handed Nick his mug and Casey made the eggnog. If anyone asks what you gave for Secret Santa, it was the reindeer.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Tell people Nick gave you your first job at 22 and you can't believe he's gone.
- Gossip: Alex Snow shouted "You'll regret this, Frost!" at about 8:00. Make sure everyone has heard.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan why they were shut in the study with Nick all afternoon.
- Ask Casey whether anyone else went near the eggnog bowl before the toast.

MINI TASK

Get at least two people to say out loud that the eggnog could have been tampered with.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: About the key log: you fetched holly for the mantel (there really is holly on the mantel). About the Secret Santa list: "Yes, I drew Nick, and I gave him the reindeer. Someone must have swapped the gifts." Steer suspicion to Morgan, who ran the Secret Santa and also had the greenhouse key.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- If anyone mentions sawdust or varnish near the study, shrug: the whole lodge smells of the workshop.
- Gossip: Morgan holds nearly every key in the lodge and ran the Secret Santa draw.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan why they went to the greenhouse at 6:00.
- Ask Frankie whether deer really get into the greenhouse.

MINI TASK

Privately convince one player that Morgan could have swapped the Secret Santa gifts.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|---------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh | ☐ Alex Snow |
| ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell | ☐ Frankie Fir |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: About the reindeer in your drawer: "I wanted to give it to him privately, later." About the bottle: anyone could have thrown it from that window. Keep pushing Morgan and Alex.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- If asked where you were at 9:50: you ran to fetch a blanket for Nick.
- If Casey mentions the saucepan: you borrowed it for gingerbread glue and left it out, so anyone could have used it after.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Alex what they were doing in the corridor at 9:45.
- Ask Charlie who else is missing from the group photo.

MINI TASK

Before voting, persuade at least one detective to accuse someone other than you.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Fill in a ballot like everyone else and accuse someone else. Do not confess until Inspector Noel reads the solution.

PLAYING ROBIN · READ THIS BEFORE ROUND 1

Your manner: Gentle, sentimental and endlessly helpful. Fuss over people, offer to fetch things, and talk about toys the way other people talk about their children.

Lines to try: "Nick gave me my first job. I owe that man everything." "Fifteen years in that workshop. Every toy has a story, you know." "Can I get anyone a mince pie? Keeping busy helps."

If someone accuses you: Look hurt, not angry: "Me? I carve teddy bears. Ask Morgan who ran that Secret Santa."

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker

Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece

Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker

Taylor Star · Hired Santa

Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener

Jamie Pudding · Village Baker

Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director

Casey Sleigh · Caterer

Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant

Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager

Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist

Riley Carol · Hired Pianist

Nick Frost · the victim